consumer is ready to deal with a premium brand like Jaguar being owned by an Indian company … When we think about India, we think about a Third World country and people going to work on their bicycles.' He said that India was not the 'appropriate home market for the luxury marque'.

Gorin, through his pronouncements, emerged as the main antagonist of the Tata Group. Newspapers reported that he had thrown in his lot with Nasser. But Gorin told me that he had not supported Nasser because he was convinced that he was the best choice. Instead, he says that the Ford 'leadership' was the reason for his support. He was asked to oppose the Tatas and publicly support Nasser, which he did out of 'loyalty' to the Ford leadership, he reveals.

Gorin, however, was not the only dealer who was apprehensive of the brand passing into the hands of an Indian company from Ford, which had owned it for about twenty years. There were many others who doubted the Tatas' capability to run the luxury brands. Some even made 'derogatory' statements against the Indian company, says Allen Aron, CEO of Imperial Motors, one of the oldest and most-awarded Jaguar dealerships in Chicago, which began its operations in 1953. Jack Weidinger, whose family had been running a Jaguar dealership outside of New York since 1938, and who was also in the Jaguar Business Operations Council, says he had heard his colleagues were 'insecure' when they heard the news of the Tatas buying the brands. He knows several people who had asked: 'What do the Indians know about running a global car company?'

Faced with the open opposition, Ratan stepped in to reassure sceptics that the Tatas could turn around the two brands. He told *The Times*, 'How a company manages products in different sectors is the key. Toyota created Lexus, Nissan has Infiniti. No one is saying "How can BMW handle the Mini?" but they've made a huge success of it. So why is it impossible?'

The newspaper casting doubts on the Tatas' capability and intentions unnerved the workforce of the two companies. The British labour leaders, representing about 16,000 Jaguar and Land Rover workers, were concerned about market positioning, outsourcing and safeguarding direct jobs.

Ratan once again took it upon himself to assuage their fears. As the head of the group, he reassured the workers that the change of ownership would not be prejudicial to their interests. Talking to Weidinger, he reiterated the Tata Group's philosophy of according high priority to safeguarding workers' interests. It would be the same in the UK as it was in India. He